

Handling your first Zillow lead

90 minutes including practice · 35 screens

Edition 2026-09-16-day2-quadrants-v2

Before you begin

Eric opens Rep, selects the training and existing agents across teams, confirms the timezone, and creates the session. The creator is the default presenter and follow-up coach. Keep the presenter console on your screen and share the separate presentation window from the same browser. Click an answer on your presenter slide to highlight it in both windows. Ask for the reasoning, then click Submit answer to share the explanation. Open Presenter notes in the toolbar for the current slide; those notes stay private. People without HQ can answer aloud and explain their choice; this discussion selection does not create an individual submission.

Ask each selected agent to open the session through their own existing login. No second invitation is needed. Confirm that everyone can join and see the current activity. Submit written work before showing the model. Give one correction, then ask for a targeted retry. Advance to the question. Agents answer and submit on that slide, and their answers appear automatically beside your slide. Review actual arrivals before revealing the example. If someone needs more time, pause or return to the slide.

In self-paced study, notes remain in the learner's browser until they choose to share them. In a live session, the presenter sees submitted answers and progress; unsubmitted writing stays private. Preserve first attempts; a retry after an example is assisted.

For remote practice, use the meeting platform's breakout rooms. Assign pairs or trios and rotate agent, buyer, and observer. In pairs, the buyer gives feedback. Every agent needs a speaking turn, one correction, and a retry. If a partner is absent, assign a coach or leave the observation outstanding.

Rehearse without agents

Create a new test session for this day without selecting agents. Open the test learner in a second tab. Advance to a vote, submit a choice, and review it in the presenter console. Reveal the example and check that it reaches the learner. Repeat with a short answer. At a breakout, choose Assign speaking turns, speak a turn, save a presenter observation, and check the feedback in the learner tab. These responses are saved only as test evidence; ending the test creates no agent assignments. Existing sessions keep their original curriculum; create a new session for this edition.

Conversation starters to keep beside you

Choose what fits the conversation. You do not need to ask every question. Start with what the buyer already told you and follow their answers.

Open the conversation

- What made you click on this particular home?
- Have you had a chance to look at other homes in the market?
- What other homes have you been considering?

- What have you liked or disliked about the homes you've seen?
- Is this your first home purchase, or have you bought before?

Understand what matters

- Where are you moving from?
- Which areas are you considering, and what draws you to them?
- What is working well in your current home?
- What would you like your next home to do differently?
- What prompted you to start looking?
- What would that extra space let you do?

Explore timing and decisions

- What timing would work best for you?
- What needs to happen before you can make a move?
- Who else would you like involved in looking at homes or making the decision?

Follow an answer

- Tell me more about that.
- What makes that important to you?
- What would that change for you?
- What would help you feel comfortable with the next step?

When a buyer raises a concern

- Acknowledge the concern: recognize the worry or frustration before moving on.
- Ask questions to understand: What part concerns you most? What happened before? What would you need to know?
- Offer a solution: propose a specific action tied to their answer, then check whether it would help.

Useful next steps may include verifying property information, comparing homes, arranging lender help when the buyer raises financing, or agreeing on a later conversation. Be accurate about your role, property status, and what you can promise. Respect the buyer's decision.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

Facilitator flow

01 / 35 · 0-1 min · Welcome

Handling your first Zillow lead

Introduce yourself. Day 1 covered the record; today teaches the conversation and the actions that belong in that record. Ask participants to open their learner session for submissions. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: What you will learn and practice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Learn how to respond to the lead, lead the first conversation, and agree on a useful next step with the buyer.

Spoken handoff: Next: What you will learn and practice. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

02 / 35 · 1-2 min · Welcome

What you will learn and practice

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: Recognize the lead and respond. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- 01Recognize the lead and respondIdentify the request before choosing your first action.
- 02Open the first conversationIntroduce yourself and invite the appointment early.
- 03Understand what the buyer needsUse each answer to choose a useful follow-up question.
- 04Work through concerns and agree on the next stepUnderstand the reason, offer useful help, and summarize the agreement.

Spoken handoff: Next: Recognize the lead and respond. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

03 / 35 · 2-2 min · 1. Recognize the lead and respond

Recognize the lead and respond

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What would you do when this lead arrives?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

01

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Spoken handoff: Next: What would you do when this lead arrives?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

What would you do when this lead arrives?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric's September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: A live connection puts a buyer on the phone. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- What would you do now?
- What would you save so the callback happens?

Spoken handoff: Next: A live connection puts a buyer on the phone. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A Zillow request reaches you at 2 p.m. The buyer writes, "I'm at work. Please call at 5 about Cedar Lane."

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

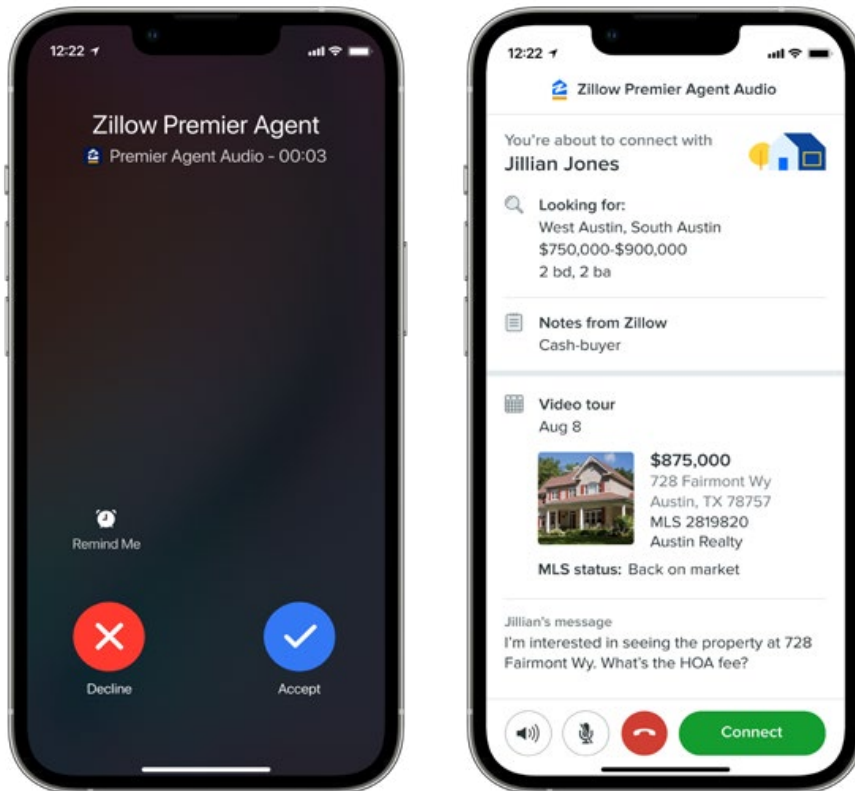
Reveal after the first response:

Acknowledge the request and introduce yourself by text now. Call at five as requested. Save the callback task. The buyer's explicit contact instruction changes the usual prompt-call approach.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

A live connection puts a buyer on the phone

Point to Accept on the first screen and Connect on the second. These are Zillow's own simulated training screens. Read the inquiry. The names and address belong to Zillow's illustration, not our later practice case. The current In-App Connections FAQ confirms answer/review/connect. Do not read every property field. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-012; Zillow Conversion Playbook Oct 2023 p7; Zillow In-App Connections FAQ Oct 2025. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Real-Time Touring asks you to accept a tour. Connect it to the action you just practiced.



Answer the incoming call. Zillow provides information about the buyer and the home before you speak to the buyer.

Read the inquiry, then connect. In this example, the buyer asks about a property's HOA fee. Begin by introducing yourself and acknowledging that question.

Source: [Zillow Conversion Playbook](#), page 7. Zillow's published demonstration; screens vary by app version.

Spoken handoff: Next: Real-Time Touring asks you to accept a tour. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Real-Time Touring asks you to accept a tour

Read the Real-Time Touring label and buyer-selected times. Distinguish Zillow's five-minute acceptance window from the five-minute first-contact standard taught here. Dates and property are sample data. Eric's "not a live call" means no live buyer conversation; do not teach that the phone never rings. Booking uses ShowingTime availability. Follow actual status and notifications. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-012; Zillow Real-Time Touring page and linked Oct 2025 demonstration. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: A standard tour request tells you what the buyer wants. Connect it to the action you just practiced.



Review the request in the app. Zillow gives you five minutes to accept a time you can attend or pass on the request.

This is not a live buyer transfer. After accepting, review the booking details and contact the buyer about the appointment.

Source: [Zillow Real-Time Touring demonstration](#). Zillow's published demonstration; screens vary by app version.

Spoken handoff: Next: A standard tour request tells you what the buyer wants. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

A standard tour request tells you what the buyer wants

Explain Follow Up Boss in full before abbreviating it to FUB. Show how the request gives you an opening. Distinguish preferred timing from booking status without making that obvious distinction into a quiz. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-012. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Give your best guess: how quickly should you call?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Read the request before you contact them. Use the property and preferred time in your opening so the buyer does not have to start over.

"I see you requested a tour Saturday afternoon. Would that still work for you? I'll check the showing arrangements and confirm the details."

A standard tour request may arrive as a live connection or an alert in Follow Up Boss. If the buyer is not already on the phone, your next job is to contact them.

Spoken handoff: Next: Give your best guess: how quickly should you call?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Give your best guess: how quickly should you call?

Ask for a choice and a reason. People without HQ access can answer aloud; select an option on your presenter slide to discuss it. Learners with access submit their own choice and explanation. Say: "Give me your best guess. Then tell me why you think timing would matter." Hear a few answers before revealing five minutes. Attribute the statistic to the 2007 InsideSales.com and James Oldroyd study, not Zillow. Do not describe higher odds as a guaranteed result for an individual buyer. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Call promptly when the buyer has asked to hear from you. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Source: [InsideSales.com / James Oldroyd, 2007 Lead Response Management Study](#). Historical web-lead research.

Within 5 minutes. The study compared calls at five minutes with calls at 30 minutes and reported 100 times higher odds of contact. It studied web leads across six companies, not Zillow buyers specifically. The practical point: respond while the request is fresh.

This is a prediction to start the discussion, not a test of a rule you have already learned. Ask what may change for a buyer while they wait. The research measured time from the web inquiry; our training standard starts when the agent receives the lead.

Spoken handoff: Next: Call promptly when the buyer has asked to hear from you. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A 2007 study of web leads found 100 times higher odds of making contact when the first call happened within ____ rather than 30 minutes. Which timeframe fills the blank? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- Within 5 minutes
- Within 10 minutes
- Within 15 minutes
- Within 20 minutes

- Why do you think the response time changes the chance of a conversation?

After submission: Within 5 minutes This is a prediction to start the discussion, not a test of a rule you have already learned. Ask what may change for a buyer while they wait. The research measured time from the web inquiry; our training standard starts when the agent receives the lead.

Reveal after the first response:

Within 5 minutes. The study compared calls at five minutes with calls at 30 minutes and reported 100 times higher odds of contact. It studied web leads across six companies, not Zillow buyers specifically. The practical point: respond while the request is fresh.

09 / 35 · 14-16 min · 1. Recognize the lead and respond

Call promptly when the buyer has asked to hear from you

Explain Eric's reason: the buyer just expressed interest, rather than being a random person being interrupted. Hearing and responding in real time matters. Do not repeat unverified response-rate statistics. The clock starts at agent receipt; do not invent after-hours rules. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-009, INT-011-013. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: If the call goes unanswered, send a personal text. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

The buyer just asked for help with a home. A call lets you hear their tone, answer questions as they arise, and begin a conversation about what they need.

Follow Up Boss may already have sent an automated introduction. That does not replace your own call. If the buyer requested a later callback or asked for text, respect that instruction.

Spoken handoff: Next: If the call goes unanswered, send a personal text. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

10 / 35 · 16-18 min · 1. Recognize the lead and respond

If the call goes unanswered, send a personal text

Read the example with your own name and brokerage. Distinguish phone-call availability from tour availability. This personal text follows the missed call. Next, explain how this first attempt fits into the ongoing outreach plan. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-011. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Keep working a new lead that has not answered. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

"Hi, this is [your name] with [your brokerage]. I just tried calling about your Zillow request to see 418 Cedar Lane. I'd be happy to help arrange a tour. I'm available for a call at 4 or 6 today. Would either time work for you?"

Tell them who called, connect the call to their request, and offer a clear opportunity to talk. Use times you can actually make. You are offering a phone call here, not confirming a tour.

Spoken handoff: Next: Keep working a new lead that has not answered. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Keep working a new lead that has not answered

These are the newer September 12 standards. Automation is not personal effort. Do not invent a compressed late-day schedule or a quota for an engaged buyer. Explain why repeating “just checking in” is not useful persistence. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-027-029, INT-054; R019. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Respond to a buyer who is at work. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Day one: Aim for three to four personal touches, with at least two calls and one personal text in the normal unanswered-lead flow.

First week: Aim for ten total touches, including day one. Make most attempts calls, vary the contact times, and make each text relevant to the inquiry.

Once the buyer responds: Follow the conversation and the plan you agree together. The unanswered-lead quota no longer applies. Honor stated contact restrictions throughout.

Spoken handoff: Next: Respond to a buyer who is at work. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Respond to a buyer who is at work

Ask for a choice and a reason. People without HQ access can answer aloud; select an option on your presenter slide to discuss it. Learners with access submit their own choice and explanation. Hear the responses first, then reinforce Eric's exception: acknowledge by text now and call at the requested time. Demonstrate “I'll be the agent calling you at five.” Then let learners choose and explain. Review whether it introduces the agent and preserves the callback. Earlier availability is optional. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Open the first conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

“Hi, I'm [your name] with [your brokerage]. I'll be the agent calling at 5 about the Cedar Lane home. If you have questions before then, you're welcome to text me.” Call at 5 as requested.

Acknowledge now so the buyer knows who will call. The requested time governs the call; the default does not justify interrupting them at work.

Spoken handoff: Next: Open the first conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A new Zillow inquiry arrives at 2 p.m. The buyer writes: “I'm at work. Please call at 5 about the Cedar Lane home.” What should you do next? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- Call now because the new-lead standard is five minutes.
- Text your introduction now, acknowledge the request, and call at 5.
- Let the automated introduction handle the acknowledgment and wait for another reply.
- Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

After submission: Text your introduction now, acknowledge the request, and call at 5. Acknowledge now so the buyer knows who will call. The requested time governs the call; the default does not justify interrupting them at work.

Reveal after the first response:

“Hi, I'm [your name] with [your brokerage]. I'll be the agent calling at 5 about the Cedar Lane home. If you have questions before then, you're welcome to text me.” Call at 5 as requested.

Open the first conversation

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: How would you open this call?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

02

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Spoken handoff: Next: How would you open this call?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

How would you open this call?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric's September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: Use LEAD to guide the conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- Say your first two sentences.
- Where would you put the appointment invitation?

Spoken handoff: Next: Use LEAD to guide the conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: George requested a tour of Cedar Lane but did not select a time. You can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Access still needs checking.

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Reveal after the first response:

Use your name, brokerage, Zillow connection and reason for calling. Invite the visit early with real availability. Then ask and listen. LEAD gives this order so the buyer's request stays central.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

Use LEAD to guide the conversation

After introducing yourself, ask for the appointment and offer two concrete times. Then ask questions that move the conversation forward: where they want to live, what prompted their search, and what matters. Use each answer to choose the next useful question. Summarize next steps to build momentum into the appointment. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016, INT-021. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Demonstration: introduce yourself and offer the visit. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- **L - Lead with who you are:** Introduce yourself: your name, brokerage, connection to Zillow, and why you're calling.

- **E - Extend the invitation:** Immediately after your introduction, ask for the appointment. Offer the buyer two concrete times to meet with you.
- **A - Ask questions that move the conversation forward:** Ask where they want to live, what prompted their search, and what matters to them. Use their answers to ask the next useful question.
- **D - Deliver the summary:** Summarize what matters to the buyer, confirm the next steps, and build momentum toward the appointment.

You may also know Zillow's ALMS: Appointment, Location, Motivation, Summarize. LEAD includes your introduction and uses location and motivation to guide your questions.

Spoken handoff: Next: Demonstration: introduce yourself and offer the visit. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

16 / 35 · 27-30 min · 2. Open the first conversation

Demonstration: introduce yourself and offer the visit

Introduce George as a fictional buyer adapted from Eric's demonstration. Read both sides. Identify name, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose. On a live transfer, say "Zillow connected us about..." Use true affiliation and availability. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Which opening serves the buyer's request?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Agent "Hi George, I'm [your name] with [your brokerage], a featured partner with Zillow. I'm calling about your request to see 418 Cedar Lane."

Agent "I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which would work better for you? I'll check access for that time."

George "Saturday morning would be good."

Spoken handoff: Next: Which opening serves the buyer's request?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

17 / 35 · 30-32 min · 2. Open the first conversation

Which opening serves the buyer's request?

Ask for a choice and a reason. People without HQ access can answer aloud; select an option on your presenter slide to discuss it. Learners with access submit their own choice and explanation. Allow a minute to respond. Ask what the interview-first agent hoped to learn, then show where discovery belongs after the invitation. Do not shame a choice. Demonstrate a revised opening. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Understand what the buyer needs. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

The appointment-first opening helps with the request immediately. Asking about readiness before offering the visit can make the buyer feel they must qualify for help. Discovery still belongs in the call, after the early invitation and permission.

An early invitation belongs here because the buyer asked to see the home. This is about order and purpose, not banning useful questions.

Spoken handoff: Next: Understand what the buyer needs. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A buyer requested a Zillow tour but selected no time. Both agents introduce themselves. Choose the continuation you would use, then explain what the other version could communicate to the buyer.

- “Before we schedule, tell me about your buying timeline and what you’re looking for.”
- “I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which works better? I’ll check the showing arrangements.”
- Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

After submission: “I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which works better? I’ll check the showing arrangements.” An early invitation belongs here because the buyer asked to see the home. This is about order and purpose, not banning useful questions.

Reveal after the first response:

The appointment-first opening helps with the request immediately. Asking about readiness before offering the visit can make the buyer feel they must qualify for help. Discovery still belongs in the call, after the early invitation and permission.

18 / 35 · 32-32 min · 3. Understand what the buyer needs

Understand what the buyer needs

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric’s September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: What would you ask about needing more space?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

03

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Spoken handoff: Next: What would you ask about needing more space?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

19 / 35 · 32-35 min · 3. Understand what the buyer needs

What would you ask about needing more space?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric’s September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: Questions you can use to start a conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- What does that tell you?
- What do you still need to understand?

Spoken handoff: Next: Questions you can use to start a conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: The buyer says, “We need more space, but we don’t want to leave our neighborhood.”

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Reveal after the first response:

Ask what the extra space would let them do. Follow the answer: a quiet work area is different from storage or a larger gathering space. Confirm your understanding before treating a feature as a requirement.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

Questions you can use to start a conversation

Give agents a usable menu, not a list they must finish. Read two or three starters and ask a volunteer to answer one. Demonstrate a follow-up based on the answer. For “more space,” ask what they need room for. For an area, ask what makes it work for them. Check that the buyer has time for the conversation. The full question bank is in the reference. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, Eric September 15 refinement; INT-016, INT-021. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Choose the next question you would ask. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- What made you click on this particular home?
- Have you had a chance to look at other homes in the market?
- What other homes have you been considering?
- Where are you moving from?
- Which areas are you considering, and what draws you to them?
- What would you like your next home to do differently?
- What prompted you to start looking?
- Is this your first home purchase, or have you bought before?
- What timing would work best for you?
- What have you liked or disliked about the homes you've seen?

Go deeper: “Tell me more about that.” · “What makes that important to you?” · “What would that change for you?”

Spoken handoff: Next: Choose the next question you would ask. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Choose the next question you would ask

Ask for a choice and a reason. People without HQ access can answer aloud; select an option on your presenter slide to discuss it. Learners with access submit their own choice and explanation. Give a minute to choose, then compare two questions. Ask what a possible answer would tell the agent. Different wording is not an error; look for curiosity tied to the situation. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Follow the answer before choosing a feature. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

“What is feeling too tight in your current home?” This could reveal whether they need bedrooms, work space, storage or something else. Then explore why staying in the neighborhood matters.

A useful question follows the buyer’s words and reveals a reason or tradeoff that shapes the search.

Spoken handoff: Next: Follow the answer before choosing a feature. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: During a first call, a buyer tells you: “We’re already in town. We need more space, but we don’t want to leave our neighborhood.” Which question would you ask first? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- “How many bedrooms do you need?”
- “What is feeling too tight in your current home?”
- “Would you consider a different neighborhood to get more space?”
- Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

After submission: “What is feeling too tight in your current home?” A useful question follows the buyer’s words and reveals a reason or tradeoff that shapes the search.

Reveal after the first response:

“What is feeling too tight in your current home?” This could reveal whether they need bedrooms, work space, storage or something else. Then explore why staying in the neighborhood matters.

22 / 35 · 40-42 min · 3. Understand what the buyer needs

Follow the answer before choosing a feature

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric’s September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: Practice a short discovery conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Agent asks

“What would the extra space let you do?”

Buyer explains

“I take work calls at the kitchen table. Everyone has to stay quiet.”

Agent follows up

“Would a separate room solve that, or do you also need distance from the main living area?”

Agent checks

“So being able to close a door and take calls matters more than the total square footage. Have I understood that?”

Spoken handoff: Next: Practice a short discovery conversation. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

23 / 35 · 42-53 min · 3. Understand what the buyer needs

Practice a short discovery conversation

1 minute setup. Buyer privately chooses a reason for needing space and reveals it after a relevant question. Each turn is 4 minutes: 2-minute conversation, 1-minute feedback, 1-minute retry. Switch buyer and agent. Final 2 minutes: debrief and reflection. Video rooms are managed in the meeting platform. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Work through concerns and agree on the next step. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

First turn: 4 minutes. Talk for two minutes, give one minute of specific feedback, then use one minute to retry.

Switch buyer and agent: 4 minutes. Use a different reason for needing space. Everyone practices speaking and listening.

Use one minute to form pairs and two minutes to debrief. Submit your reflection when you return.

Choose a relevant starter, explore the current situation, and follow the answer. Learning that the buyer works at the kitchen table points toward a work-space need, not automatically more bedrooms.

Record what you actually learned and changed. Reflection does not prove a coach observed the call.

Spoken handoff: Next: Work through concerns and agree on the next step. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: One person plays a buyer who wants to stay in the neighborhood but needs more space. The other plays the agent, after an appointment has been discussed. Choose a conversation starter, then find out what “more space” means.

- What did you learn that “more space” did not tell you?
- What feedback did you receive, and what changed on your retry?

Observer criteria:

- Uses a relevant conversation starter
- Follows a buyer answer rather than switching to a checklist

Reveal after the first response:

Choose a relevant starter, explore the current situation, and follow the answer. Learning that the buyer works at the kitchen table points toward a work-space need, not automatically more bedrooms.

24 / 35 · 53-53 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Next: Common objections you may hear. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

04

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Spoken handoff: Next: Common objections you may hear. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

25 / 35 · 53-55 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Common objections you may hear

Invite two people to name a concern they have heard. Do not diagnose it from the label alone: “not ready” could mean timing, money, uncertainty, or simply wanting information first. You do not need a separate memorized speech for each item. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, Eric September 15 objection framework; INT-016-018. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: What would you ask before offering a solution?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- “I only had a question about the home.”
- “I’m not ready to buy yet.”
- “I’m uncertain about the market.”
- “I’m worried about the monthly payment.”
- “We need to sell our home first.”
- “The home I wanted is already under contract.”

- “I only want to speak with the listing agent.”
- “I don’t want to commit to an agent yet.”

Which have you heard? What did the buyer actually need help understanding?

Spoken handoff: Next: What would you ask before offering a solution?. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

26 / 35 · 55-58 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

What would you ask before offering a solution?

Present the situation without giving the answer. Allow a quiet first response, then hear two different approaches. Recognize sound reasoning and identify gaps before moving to the teaching slides. This discussion is ungraded. Sources: Eric’s September 16 teaching format; existing TRU curriculum. Handoff: Next: Understand the concern before offering help. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- What might they mean by “uncertain”?
- How would different answers change the help you offer?

Spoken handoff: Next: Understand the concern before offering help. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: The buyer says they are uncertain about the market and hesitate when you offer a visit.

- What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Reveal after the first response:

Ask what part concerns them. A fear of choosing the wrong home calls for different help than uncertainty about payment. Offer an action based on the answer and check whether it would help. Avoid predictions or pressure.

Coach-led discussion. No automatic grade. Ask learners to explain their reasoning and what information would change their recommendation.

27 / 35 · 58-60 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Understand the concern before offering help

Model empathy without assuming you know the problem. Ask before prescribing. A question about the roof may be about repair costs or a previous bad experience. A market concern may be about timing, payment, or making the wrong choice. The solution should follow the answer. If the buyer declines, respect that and agree on an appropriate next step. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, Eric September 15 objection framework. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: “I’m uncertain about the market right now.”. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- **Acknowledge the concern:** Recognize what feels difficult or uncertain. “I hear you - this is a big decision.”
- **Ask questions to understand:** Find out what is underneath it. “What part is worrying you most?” Then follow their answer.
- **Offer a solution:** Propose a specific next step that addresses what you learned. Explain how it helps, then ask, “Would that be useful?”

An objection is not resolved just because you delivered a response. Listen to whether the proposed next step actually helps.

Spoken handoff: Next: “I’m uncertain about the market right now.”. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

“I’m uncertain about the market right now.”

Read the buyer’s concern before the response. Emphasize that this buyer is worried about choosing the wrong home; we learned that by asking. Do not use the same solution automatically if the concern is affordability or a need to sell first. Do not predict rates or prices. Explain actual touring agreements accurately if asked; do not promise there are no forms or obligations. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, Eric September 15 objection framework.

Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: A property question may have a concern behind it. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Acknowledge “I hear you. It’s a big decision, and you want to feel comfortable with it.”

Ask “What is worrying you most about buying right now?”

Buyer “I’m worried we’ll rush and choose the wrong home.”

Offer a solution “We can use a visit to learn what works for you and compare it with other options. You don’t have to decide to buy today. Would seeing it with that purpose help?”

Spoken handoff: Next: A property question may have a concern behind it. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

A property question may have a concern behind it

Ask for a choice and a reason. People without HQ access can answer aloud; select an option on your presenter slide to discuss it. Learners with access submit their own choice and explanation. Take a choice and a reason, then ask two volunteers to say their own version using acknowledge, ask, and offer. Compare what each response assumes. Acknowledge does not mean pretending to know how the buyer feels. A useful solution follows the buyer’s answer. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Summarize the buyer’s priorities and the plan. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

“After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you want to know before feeling comfortable taking another look? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step from there.” Then listen. The buyer may need repair records, an answer about age, or help understanding what remains unknown. Do not guess the facts or make the answer conditional on a visit.

The response recognizes the experience, asks what information would help, and offers to verify it. An invitation can follow when it helps with the concern; it should not skip over the concern.

Spoken handoff: Next: Summarize the buyer’s priorities and the plan. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A buyer says, “I only wanted to know about the roof. Our last house had an expensive leak, and I’m not ready to schedule anything.” You have not verified the roof information. Which response best acknowledges, explores, and offers relevant help? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- “I understand why you’re cautious. Let’s tour it first so you can see how much you like it.”
- “That sounds frustrating. I’ll send you the roof age when I find it, and you can call me when you’re ready.”
- “After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you need to know to feel comfortable? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step.”
- Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

After submission: “After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you need to know to feel comfortable? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step.” The response recognizes the experience, asks what information would help, and offers to verify it. An invitation can follow when it helps with the concern; it should not skip over the concern.

Reveal after the first response:

“After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you want to know before feeling comfortable taking another look? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step from there.” Then listen. The buyer may need repair records, an answer about age, or help understanding what remains unknown. Do not guess the facts or make the answer conditional on a visit.

30 / 35 · 65-68 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Summarize the buyer’s priorities and the plan

Trace each fact to the case. Comparison consent is supplied here; it is not assumed from interest. The full call shows how to ask. Avoid generic promises about every state or form. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016, INT-023, INT-035. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Close a call when the buyer cannot tour yet. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

“You’d like a shorter commute and a sunny space for a vegetable garden. We’re aiming for Saturday morning. I’ll check access to Cedar Lane and research another home to compare. I’ll text you the confirmed details once I have them. Have I understood everything correctly?”

Before ending, confirm the communication plan and explain the applicable touring form. Describe its actual terms and what the buyer will receive.

Spoken handoff: Next: Close a call when the buyer cannot tour yet. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

31 / 35 · 68-70 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Close a call when the buyer cannot tour yet

Ask for a choice and a reason. People without HQ access can answer aloud; select an option on your presenter slide to discuss it. Learners with access submit their own choice and explanation. Allow a minute to choose and explain. Check that answers distinguish the relocation timeline from the next call. Do not invent a showing or say properties were already sent. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Run a first call and retry one part. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

“You’re planning to relocate in two months and need space for a home office. I’ll email three homes for you to look over, and we’ll talk Tuesday at six about what fits. Is there anything else you’d like me to keep in mind?”

A useful next step does not always mean a near-term showing. Reflect the timeline and agreement instead of forcing the tour example onto this buyer.

Spoken handoff: Next: Run a first call and retry one part. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: A buyer is relocating in two months. They want room for a home office and cannot visit this week. You agreed to email three possible homes and speak Tuesday at 6 p.m. Which closing reflects that agreement? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- “Let’s get a tour scheduled this week so you can decide before you move.”
- “I’ll send some listings. Let me know if anything catches your eye.”
- “You’re moving in two months and need a home office. I’ll email three homes, and we’ll talk Tuesday at 6.”
- Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

After submission: “You’re moving in two months and need a home office. I’ll email three homes, and we’ll talk Tuesday at 6.” A useful next step does not always mean a near-term showing. Reflect the timeline and agreement instead of forcing the tour example onto this buyer.

Reveal after the first response:

“You’re planning to relocate in two months and need space for a home office. I’ll email three homes for you to look over, and we’ll talk Tuesday at six about what fits. Is there anything else you’d like me to keep in mind?”

32 / 35 · 70-86 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Run a first call and retry one part

1 minute setup: assign trios and open meeting-platform rooms. Three rounds of 4 minutes: 2-minute call, 1-minute observer feedback, 1-minute targeted retry. Rotate all roles. Reserve 3 minutes for debrief and submissions. Buyer uses the assigned case; do not give the agent hidden buyer reasons before the call. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Save the details that make your next contact useful. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Three rounds, four minutes each. Two minutes for the call, one minute for feedback, then a one-minute retry.

Rotate all three roles. Everyone takes a turn as agent, buyer and observer. Use one minute to set up and three minutes to debrief and submit.

Introduce yourself, help with the request, ask permission, learn location and motivation, and summarize the actual plan. Adapt to the buyer’s question or time constraint. Report the conversation you practiced.

Everyone needs a speaking turn and a chance to improve a specific sentence. Peer feedback and reflection are not coach sign-off.

Spoken handoff: Next: Save the details that make your next contact useful. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

Participant task: Work in trios. The buyer uses an assigned fictional case; the agent responds to what the buyer says. The observer listens for an early invitation, useful follow-up questions and an accurate closing.

- What did you learn about your buyer?
- What specific feedback did the observer give?
- What changed when you tried that part again?

Observer criteria:

- Identifies agent, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose
- Helps with the appointment early while respecting the request
- Asks permission and follows an answer
- Restates priorities and the agreed next action
- Responds usefully to the buyer’s question or time constraint

Reveal after the first response:

Introduce yourself, help with the request, ask permission, learn location and motivation, and summarize the actual plan. Adapt to the buyer's question or time constraint. Report the conversation you practiced.

33 / 35 · 86-88 min · 4. Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Save the details that make your next contact useful

Connect to Day 1. Separate facts learned from actions owed. Ask what would be lost if the note only said “wants to tour.” Do not mark an appointment confirmed without supporting arrangements. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, R020-R021; INT-035-039. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: From the next lead to the next step. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

FUB note: Rents locally. Wants a shorter commute near Cedar Lane and sun for raised vegetable beds. Open to another home for comparison. Prefers Saturday morning. Text is the agreed channel. Tour access is not yet confirmed.

Next task: Check access, research a relevant comparison, and text George the details. Set the task for the follow-up time you agreed.

Spoken handoff: Next: From the next lead to the next step. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

34 / 35 · 88-89 min · Review and reference

From the next lead to the next step

Close the training rather than introducing another lesson. Review the four outcomes briefly. Ask each learner which part they want to keep practicing, using their role-play experience. Remind them the reference includes questions they can keep beside them. Practice today is a starting point, not proof of mastery. Sources: TRU September 12 teaching, INT-016. Examples are fictional unless credited to Zillow. Use true names, brokerage, availability and property facts. Handoff: Next: Use this training after the session. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

- **Recognize the lead.** Know whether you are joining a live buyer or responding to a new request.
- **Start the conversation.** Respond promptly, introduce yourself, and offer a useful appointment.
- **Understand the buyer.** Follow their answers and work through concerns with empathy, questions, and a solution.
- **Agree and follow through.** Summarize the plan, record it in FUB, and do what you promised.

Keep your conversation starters and practice reference handy ■

Spoken handoff: Next: Use this training after the session. Connect it to the action you just practiced.

35 / 35 · 89-90 min · Review and reference

Use this training after the session

Use the visible explanation as the teaching reference. Ask what the agent would do, hear the reason, then demonstrate the steps. Fictional examples illustrate the existing TRU process. Sources: existing day curriculum; Eric's September 16 quadrant and independent-review requirements. Handoff: Return to the relevant quadrant when you need the steps, then practice again.

Find the topic

Use the four sections to return to the action you need. Read the example and the reason for the next step.

Practice again

Answer the scenario before opening its explanation. For a conversation exercise, use the buyer card with a partner, get one specific correction, and retry.

Keep a reference

Download the agent reference for the teaching and examples. Keep practice notes separate from real customer records.

Spoken handoff: Return to the relevant quadrant when you need the steps, then practice again.

Buyer practice cards

Tour request · a home office

I asked to see the Cedar Lane home. Saturday morning works for me.

Fictional buyer: you rent locally and work at the kitchen table. You need a separate work space and want to stay near your neighborhood. Reveal the reason after a relevant question. You are open to a comparison home. Access has not been checked.

Property question · maintenance

I wanted to know about the roof before deciding whether to tour.

Fictional buyer: surprise maintenance costs concern you. The agent does not have verified roof information. Explain the concern when asked. Prefer a call with verified information before booking; do not agree merely because the invitation is repeated.

Relocation · a later visit

We are relocating in two months. We cannot see homes this week.

Fictional buyer: you need room for a home office. You can review emailed properties and talk Tuesday at six. Share details after relevant questions. The useful next step is planning, not a forced immediate showing.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References and certification

Updated September 16, 2026 from the existing Day 2 workshop and Eric's approved interactive-training plan. TRU sales doctrine remains the source for coaching the first call and follow-up.

- Your coach and approved team workflow.

Existing quizzes, pass thresholds, and certification records continue through the normal Rep course flow. The presentation link is not a certification attempt.